

LOFIBUDDHA



Yoga Foundations – 7 Essential Poses

LofiBuddha – a guide for your practice



A beginner's guide to the mat

No flexibility required. Come as you are.

1. Mountain Pose (Tadasana)

The foundation of all standing poses.

- Stand with feet hip-width apart.
- Root down through all four corners of your feet.
- Lift your kneecaps, engage your thighs.
- Lengthen your spine. Crown of the head reaches toward the sky.
- Shoulders roll back and down. Palms face forward.
- Breathe deeply for 5-10 breaths.

Why: Teaches alignment and body awareness. Looks simple — is surprisingly challenging when done with full attention.

2. Cat-Cow (Marjaryasana-Bitilasana)

A gentle, flowing warm-up for the spine.

- Start on hands and knees. Wrists under shoulders, knees under hips.
- **Inhale (Cow):** Drop belly, lift gaze, tailbone reaches up.
- **Exhale (Cat):** Round spine, tuck chin to chest, tailbone tucks under.
- Flow with your breath for 2-3 minutes.

Why: Releases tension in the spine, neck, and shoulders. Connects breath with movement.

3. Child's Pose (Balasana)

Rest. Surrender. Breathe into your back body.

- Knees wide, big toes touching.
- Fold forward. Forehead to the ground.
- Arms extended forward or resting alongside your body.
- Breathe deeply into your back — feel it expand.
- Stay 2-5 minutes.

Why: The ultimate rest pose. Calms the nervous system. Return here anytime you need a break.

4. Downward Dog (Adho Mukha Svanasana)

Strength meets surrender.

- From hands and knees, tuck your toes and lift your hips toward the sky.
- Hands shoulder-width, feet hip-width.
- Pedal out your feet. Bend one knee, then the other.
- Let your head hang heavy. Gaze between your feet or toward your navel.
- Hold 5-10 breaths.

Why: Builds upper body strength, stretches hamstrings and calves, energizes the body.

5. Warrior I (Virabhadrasana I)

Feel your power in stillness.

- From Downward Dog, step your right foot forward between your hands.
- Bend the front knee to 90 degrees, directly over the ankle.
- Back leg straight, heel grounded at a 45-degree angle.
- Arms reach up alongside your ears. Gaze forward or slightly up.
- Hold 5-8 breaths. Switch sides.

Why: Builds leg strength, opens hips and chest, cultivates grounded confidence.

6. Tree Pose (Vrksasana)

Finding balance in stillness.

- Shift weight to your left foot.
- Place your right foot on your ankle, calf, or inner thigh (never the knee).
- Hands at heart center or reaching up like branches.
- Find a focal point to gaze at. Breathe.
- Hold 5-10 breaths. Switch sides.

Why: Improves balance, focus, and ankle stability. Teaches patience with yourself.

7. Savasana (Corpse Pose)

The hardest pose. Do not skip.

- Lie flat on your back.
- Arms slightly away from body, palms up.
- Legs relaxed, feet falling open.
- Let go completely — jaw, tongue, shoulders, hips.
- Stay 5-10 minutes.

Why: Integrates your practice. Teaches deep release. The pose where yoga truly happens.

Practice Notes

- Never force or push through pain. Sensation is fine. Sharp pain is not.
- Breathe through your nose throughout. If you're holding your breath, you're pushing too hard.
- Consistency over intensity. 15 minutes daily > 90 minutes weekly.
- End every practice with Savasana. It's not optional.

Lofibuddha Yoga Foundations – Part of the Mindful Path